

Shooting Lab EDA

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Data Set:

```
library(readr)

shooting_data <- read_csv("capstone2026.csv")

## Rows: 25868 Columns: 262
## -- Column specification -----
## Delimiter: ","
## chr   (5): Name, Date, Shot.Type, Shot.Location, PlayerID
## dbl (256): Shot.Distance, Shot.X.Pos, Shot.Y.Pos, Ball_Depth, left_right, Ba...
## lgl   (1): Made
##
## i Use 'spec()' to retrieve the full column specification for this data.
## i Specify the column types or set 'show_col_types = FALSE' to quiet this message.
```

```
library(dplyr)

##
## Attaching package: 'dplyr'

## The following objects are masked from 'package:stats':
##
##   filter, lag

## The following objects are masked from 'package:base':
##
##   intersect, setdiff, setequal, union
```

```
shooting_data %>%
  group_by(Name) %>%
  count()
```

```
## # A tibble: 165 x 2
## # Groups:   Name [165]
##   Name          n
##   <chr>        <int>
## 1 Player 1      77
```

```
## 2 Player 10    130
## 3 Player 100     3
## 4 Player 101   106
## 5 Player 102 1494
## 6 Player 103   326
## 7 Player 104   150
## 8 Player 105    55
## 9 Player 106    59
## 10 Player 107   47
## # i 155 more rows
```

Filter for Freethrows and more than 20 shots:

```
freethrows = shooting_data %>%
  filter(Shot.Location == "Free Throw")

head(freethrows)
```

```
## # A tibble: 6 x 262
##   Name   Date Shot.Type Shot.Location Shot.Distance Shot.X.Pos Shot.Y.Pos Made
##   <chr> <chr> <chr>      <chr>          <dbl>      <dbl>      <dbl> <lgl>
## 1 Playe~ 5/27~ Off the ~ Free Throw          13.8        0.750        13.8 TRUE
## 2 Playe~ 5/27~ Off the ~ Free Throw          13.8        0.849        13.8 TRUE
## 3 Playe~ 5/27~ Off the ~ Free Throw          13.8        0.714        13.8 TRUE
## 4 Playe~ 5/27~ Off the ~ Free Throw          13.9        0.736        13.8 TRUE
## 5 Playe~ 5/27~ Off the ~ Free Throw          13.8        0.707        13.8 TRUE
## 6 Playe~ 5/27~ Off the ~ Free Throw          13.8        0.800        13.8 TRUE
## # i 254 more variables: Ball_Depth <dbl>, left_right <dbl>,
## #   Ball.Distance.from.Center <dbl>, Ball_to_Rim_Angle <dbl>,
## #   Ball_Velocity <dbl>, Release.Height <dbl>, Initial.Ball.Angle <dbl>,
## #   Initial.Ball.Velocity <dbl>, Starting.Ball.Height <dbl>,
## #   Max.Ball.Arc <dbl>, Pass.Direction <dbl>, timeAtStartofMovement <dbl>,
## #   timeAtStartofHitch <dbl>, timeAtEndofHitch <dbl>, timeAtRelease <dbl>,
## #   TotalShotTime <dbl>, Pre.Hitch.Time <dbl>, Hitch.Time <dbl>, ...
```

```
summary(freethrows$Made)
```

```
##      Mode    FALSE      TRUE
## logical      716     3251
```

```
freethrows %>%
  group_by(PlayerID) %>%
  count()
```

```
## # A tibble: 136 x 2
## # Groups:   PlayerID [136]
##   PlayerID      n
##   <chr>      <int>
## 1 Player 1      19
## 2 Player 10     32
```

```
## 3 Player 100      2
## 4 Player 101     26
## 5 Player 102    100
## 6 Player 103     52
## 7 Player 104     32
## 8 Player 106      6
## 9 Player 107     17
## 10 Player 108     5
## # i 126 more rows
```

```
ft_counts <- shooting_data %>%
  filter(Shot.Location == "Free Throw") %>%
  count(Name, name = "n_free_throws") %>%
  arrange(desc(n_free_throws))

ft_counts
```

```
## # A tibble: 136 x 2
##   Name      n_free_throws
##   <chr>          <int>
## 1 Player 116          245
## 2 Player 163          172
## 3 Player 158          135
## 4 Player 102          100
## 5 Player 120           93
## 6 Player 145           80
## 7 Player 64           80
## 8 Player 54           78
## 9 Player 23           74
## 10 Player 98           66
## # i 126 more rows
```

```
freethrows_20 <- shooting_data %>%
  filter(Shot.Location == "Free Throw") %>%
  group_by(Name) %>%
  filter(n() >= 20) %>%
  ungroup()

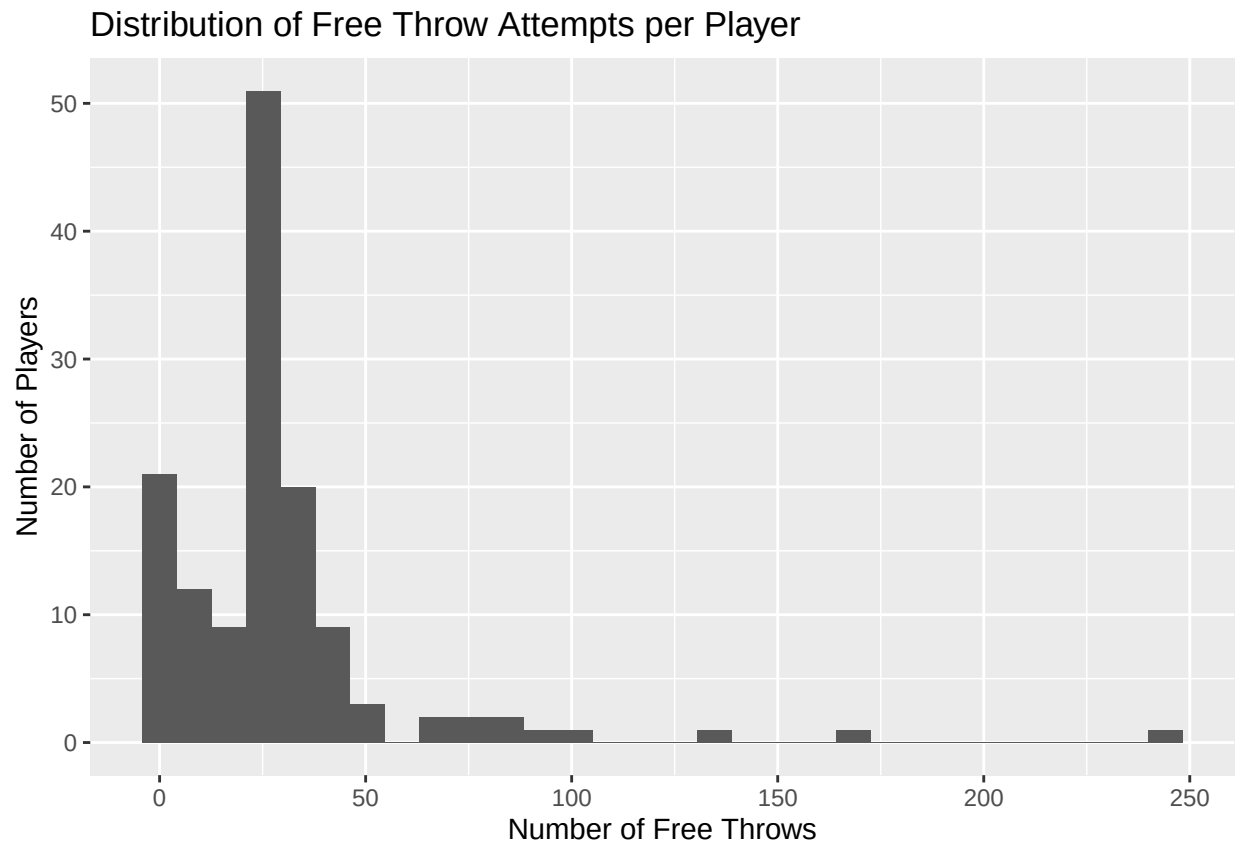
freethrows_20 <- freethrows_20 %>%
  mutate(
    made_num = ifelse(Made == TRUE, 1, 0)
  )
```

Distribution of Shots

```
library(ggplot2)

shooting_data %>%
  filter(Shot.Location == "Free Throw") %>%
```

```
count(Name, name = "n_shots") %>%
ggplot(aes(x = n_shots)) +
geom_histogram(bins = 30) +
labs(
  title = "Distribution of Free Throw Attempts per Player",
  x = "Number of Free Throws",
  y = "Number of Players"
)
```



Variable Correlations

```
library(tidyr)

shot_corrs <- freethrows_20 %>%
  select(
    Made,
    Ball_to_Rim_Angle,
    Ball_Velocity,
    Initial.Ball.Angle,
    Initial.Ball.Velocity,
    Starting.Ball.Height,
    Release.Height,
    Max.Ball.Arc,
```

```

    TotalShotTime,
    Pre.Hitch.Time,
    Hitch.Time,
    Post.Hitch.Time,
    PercTimePreHitch,
    PercTimeHitch,
    PercTimePostHitch
  )

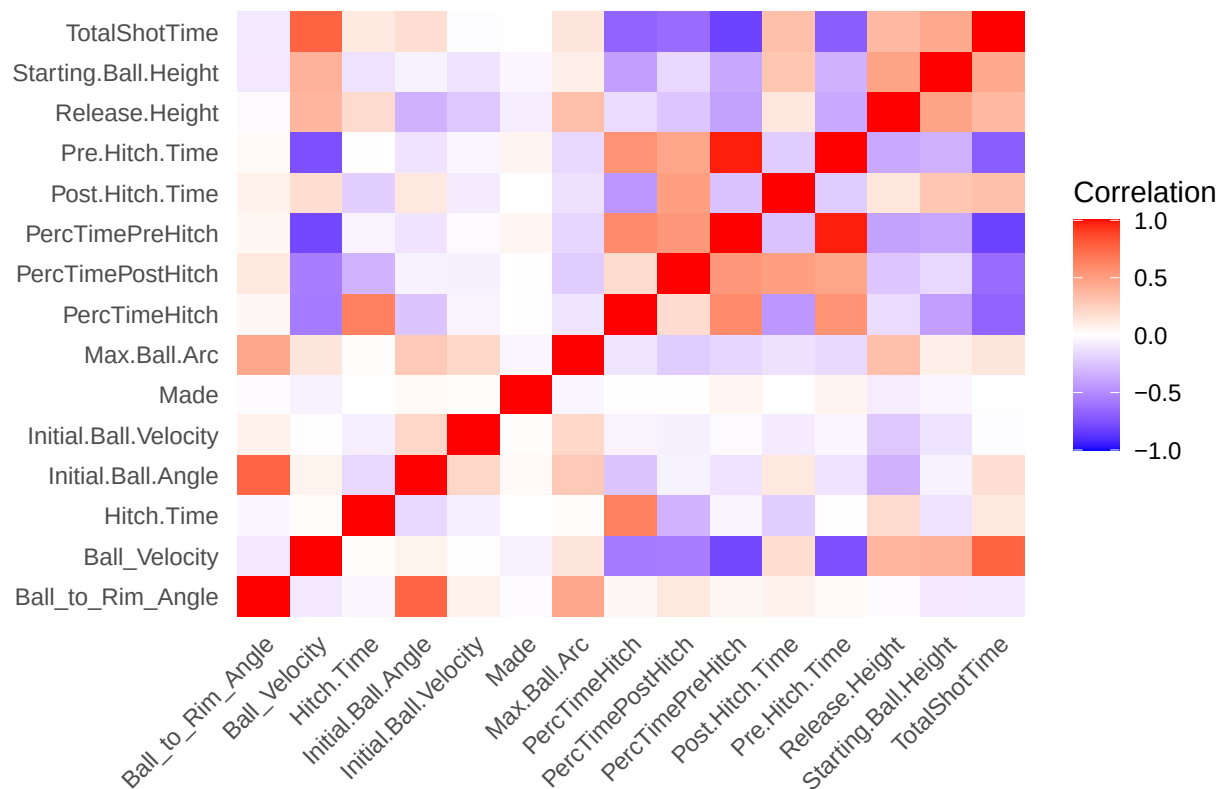
cor_matrix <- cor(shot_corrs, use = "complete.obs")

cor_long <- as.data.frame(cor_matrix) %>%
  mutate(Variable1 = rownames(.)) %>%
  pivot_longer(
    cols = -Variable1,
    names_to = "Variable2",
    values_to = "Correlation"
  )

ggplot(cor_long, aes(x = Variable1, y = Variable2, fill = Correlation)) +
  geom_tile() +
  scale_fill_gradient2(
    low = "blue",
    mid = "white",
    high = "red",
    midpoint = 0,
    limits = c(-1, 1)
  ) +
  theme_minimal() +
  theme(
    axis.text.x = element_text(angle = 45, hjust = 1),
    panel.grid = element_blank()
  ) +
  labs(
    title = "Correlation Heatmap: Free Throw Trajectory & Rhythm Variables",
    x = NULL,
    y = NULL
  )

```

Correlation Heatmap: Free Throw Trajectory & Rhythm Variables



```
library(tidyverse)
```

```
## -- Attaching core tidyverse packages ----- tidyverse 2.0.0 --
## v forcats 1.0.0      v stringr 1.5.1
## v lubridate 1.9.3    v tibble 3.2.1
## v purrr 1.1.0
## -- Conflicts ----- tidyverse_conflicts() --
## x dplyr::filter() masks stats::filter()
## x dplyr::lag() masks stats::lag()
## i Use the conflicted package (<http://conflicted.r-lib.org/>) to force all conflicts to become errors
```

```
made_corr <- cor_matrix[, "Made"] %>%
  as.data.frame() %>%
  rownames_to_column("Variable")

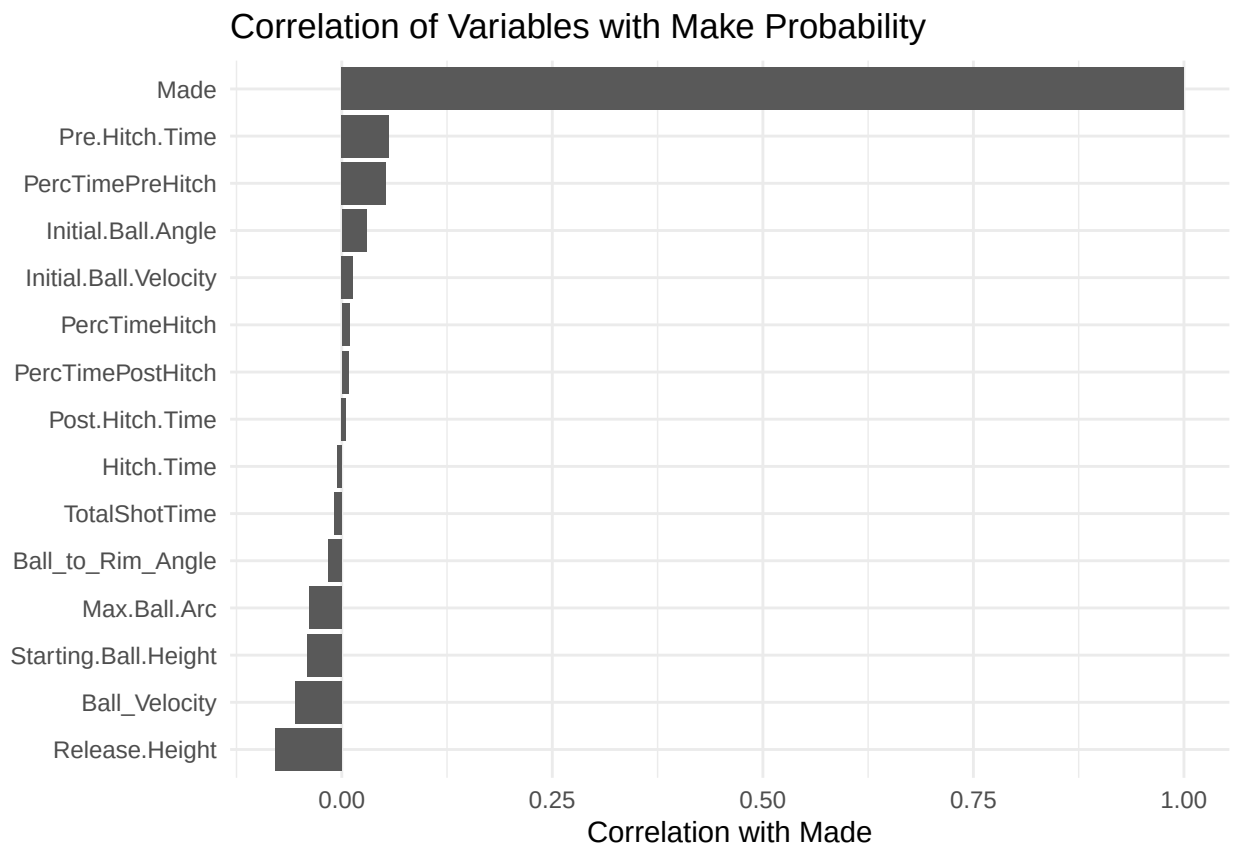
colnames(made_corr)[2] <- "Correlation_with_Made"

made_corr %>%
  arrange(desc(abs(Correlation_with_Made)))
```

```
##           Variable Correlation_with_Made
## 1           Made          1.000000000
## 2 Release.Height        -0.078623419
## 3 Pre.Hitch.Time         0.056086938
```

## 4	Ball_Velocity	-0.055660258
## 5	PercTimePreHitch	0.052678164
## 6	Starting.Ball.Height	-0.040579798
## 7	Max.Ball.Arc	-0.038977859
## 8	Initial.Ball.Angle	0.029616762
## 9	Ball_to_Rim_Angle	-0.016148634
## 10	Initial.Ball.Velocity	0.013197021
## 11	PercTimeHitch	0.009291658
## 12	TotalShotTime	-0.008499761
## 13	PercTimePostHitch	0.008134937
## 14	Hitch.Time	-0.005468104
## 15	Post.Hitch.Time	0.005087644

```
ggplot(made_corr, aes(
  x = reorder(Variable, Correlation_with_Made),
  y = Correlation_with_Made
)) +
  geom_col() +
  coord_flip() +
  theme_minimal() +
  labs(
    title = "Correlation of Variables with Make Probability",
    x = NULL,
    y = "Correlation with Made"
  )
)
```



```

var_summary = freethrows_20 %>%
  group_by(Made) %>%
  summarise(
    across(
      c(Ball_to_Rim_Angle,
        Ball_Velocity,
        Initial.Ball.Angle,
        Initial.Ball.Velocity,
        Starting.Ball.Height,
        Release.Height,
        Max.Ball.Arc,
        TotalShotTime,
        Pre.Hitch.Time,
        Hitch.Time,
        Post.Hitch.Time,
        PercTimePreHitch,
        PercTimeHitch,
        PercTimePostHitch),
      list(
        mean = ~mean(.x, na.rm = TRUE),
        sd   = ~sd(.x, na.rm = TRUE)
      )
    ),
    n = n()
  )

```

```
var_summary
```

```

## # A tibble: 2 x 30
##   Made Ball_to_Rim_Angle_mean Ball_to_Rim_Angle_sd Ball_Velocity_mean
##   <lgl>          <dbl>          <dbl>          <dbl>
## 1 FALSE             45.0             3.39             3.40
## 2 TRUE              44.9             3.00             3.20
## # i 26 more variables: Ball_Velocity_sd <dbl>, Initial.Ball.Angle_mean <dbl>,
## #   Initial.Ball.Angle_sd <dbl>, Initial.Ball.Velocity_mean <dbl>,
## #   Initial.Ball.Velocity_sd <dbl>, Starting.Ball.Height_mean <dbl>,
## #   Starting.Ball.Height_sd <dbl>, Release.Height_mean <dbl>,
## #   Release.Height_sd <dbl>, Max.Ball.Arc_mean <dbl>, Max.Ball.Arc_sd <dbl>,
## #   TotalShotTime_mean <dbl>, TotalShotTime_sd <dbl>,
## #   Pre.Hitch.Time_mean <dbl>, Pre.Hitch.Time_sd <dbl>, ...

```

```

library(dplyr)
library(tidyr)

# Separate made and miss rows
made_stats <- var_summary %>% filter(Made == TRUE)
miss_stats <- var_summary %>% filter(Made == FALSE)

# Extract means
made_means <- made_stats %>%
  select(ends_with("_mean")) %>%
  pivot_longer(everything(),
    names_to = "variable",

```



```

      values_to = "mean_made") %>%
mutate(variable = sub("_mean", "", variable))

miss_means <- miss_stats %>%
  select(ends_with("_mean")) %>%
  pivot_longer(everything(),
               names_to = "variable",
               values_to = "mean_miss") %>%
  mutate(variable = sub("_mean", "", variable))

# Extract sds
made_sd <- made_stats %>%
  select(ends_with("_sd")) %>%
  pivot_longer(everything(),
               names_to = "variable",
               values_to = "sd_made") %>%
  mutate(variable = sub("_sd", "", variable))

miss_sd <- miss_stats %>%
  select(ends_with("_sd")) %>%
  pivot_longer(everything(),
               names_to = "variable",
               values_to = "sd_miss") %>%
  mutate(variable = sub("_sd", "", variable))

# Combine
effect_sizes <- made_means %>%
  left_join(miss_means, by = "variable") %>%
  left_join(made_sd, by = "variable") %>%
  left_join(miss_sd, by = "variable") %>%
  mutate(
    pooled_sd = sqrt((sd_made^2 + sd_miss^2)/2),
    cohens_d = (mean_made - mean_miss)/pooled_sd,
    abs_d = abs(cohens_d)
  ) %>%
  arrange(desc(abs_d))

effect_sizes

```

```

## # A tibble: 14 x 8
##   variable      mean_made mean_miss sd_made sd_miss pooled_sd cohens_d abs_d
##   <chr>          <dbl>     <dbl>   <dbl>   <dbl>   <dbl>    <dbl> <dbl>
## 1 Release.Height 2.54      2.56    0.128   0.134    0.131   -0.204 0.204
## 2 Pre.Hitch.Time 0.641     0.555   0.595   0.514    0.556    0.154 0.154
## 3 Ball_Velocity 3.20      3.40    1.38    1.30     1.34   -0.149 0.149
## 4 PercTimePreHit~ 1.19      1.00    1.36    1.18     1.27    0.144 0.144
## 5 Starting.Ball.~ 1.08      1.10    0.211   0.227    0.219   -0.104 0.104
## 6 Max.Ball.Arc   3.94      3.96    0.215   0.244    0.230   -0.0980 0.0980
## 7 Initial.Ball.A~ 48.5      48.2    2.94    3.29     3.12    0.0748 0.0748
## 8 Ball_to_Rim_An~ 44.9      45.0    3.00    3.39     3.20   -0.0406 0.0406
## 9 Initial.Ball.V~ 6.55      6.54    0.214   0.298    0.259    0.0308 0.0308
## 10 PercTimeHitch 0.377     0.374   0.139   0.136    0.138    0.0245 0.0245
## 11 TotalShotTime 0.696     0.700   0.167   0.163    0.165   -0.0224 0.0224

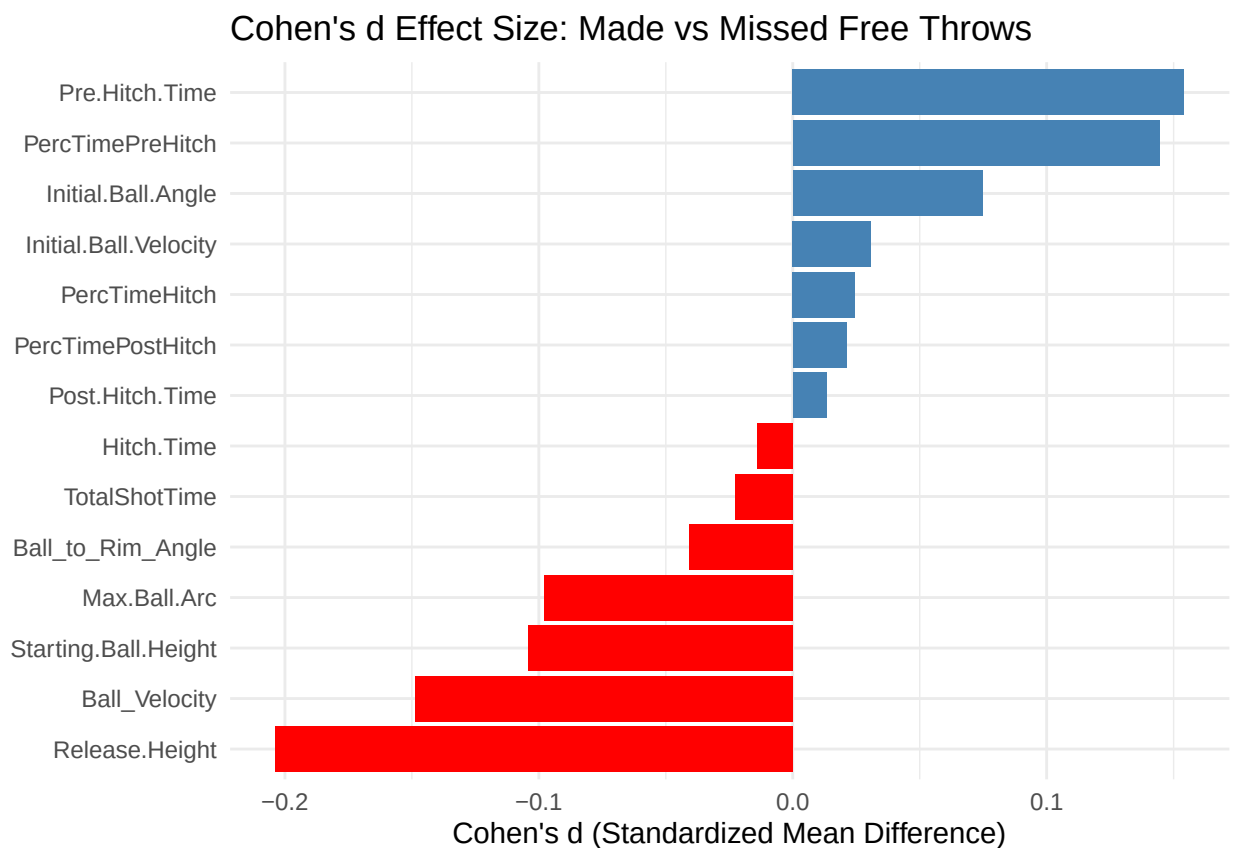
```

## 12 PercTimePostHi~	0.373	0.370	0.113	0.116	0.115	0.0212	0.0212
## 13 Hitch.Time	0.246	0.247	0.0707	0.0778	0.0743	-0.0139	0.0139
## 14 Post.Hitch.Time	0.247	0.247	0.0628	0.0647	0.0637	0.0132	0.0132

Standardized mean differences between made and missed free throws were uniformly small ($|d| < 0.21$), indicating that no single trajectory or timing variable independently explains shot success. This suggests that shot outcome is likely influenced by multivariate interactions rather than dominant individual predictors.

```
library(ggplot2)

ggplot(effect_sizes, aes(
  x = reorder(variable, cohens_d),
  y = cohens_d,
  fill = cohens_d > 0
)) +
  geom_col() +
  coord_flip() +
  scale_fill_manual(values = c("red", "steelblue"), guide = "none") +
  theme_minimal() +
  labs(
    title = "Cohen's d Effect Size: Made vs Missed Free Throws",
    x = NULL,
    y = "Cohen's d (Standardized Mean Difference)"
  )
)
```



Pre.Hitch.Time and PercTimePreHitch:

- Slightly higher for made shots
- makes tend to have a slightly longer setup phase.

Release.Height and Ball_Velocity

- Slightly higher for missed shots
- misses may be released a bit higher and enter the rim slightly faster.

```
player_summary <- freethrows_20 %>%
  group_by(Name) %>%
  summarise(
    attempts = n(),
    makes = sum(made_num),
    FT_pct = mean(Made),
    avg_entry_angle = mean(Ball_to_Rim_Angle),
    avg_arc = mean(Max.Ball.Arc),
    avg_release_angle = mean(Initial.Ball.Angle),
    avg_velocity = mean(Initial.Ball.Velocity),
    avg_total_time = mean(TotalShotTime),
    .groups = "drop"
  ) %>%
  arrange(desc(FT_pct))
```

player_summary

```
## # A tibble: 97 x 9
##   Name      attempts makes FT_pct avg_entry_angle avg_arc avg_release_angle
##   <chr>      <int> <dbl> <dbl>      <dbl>    <dbl>      <dbl>
## 1 Player 68      37    36 0.973      48.1     4.16      52.8
## 2 Player 20      34    33 0.971      43.7     3.95      48.6
## 3 Player 147     31    30 0.968      41.2     3.83      47.2
## 4 Player 162     28    27 0.964      47.3     3.95      47.5
## 5 Player 73      27    26 0.963      43.4     3.99      48.0
## 6 Player 101     26    25 0.962      48.5     4.24      51.3
## 7 Player 14      25    24 0.96       45.7     3.90      47.4
## 8 Player 160     25    24 0.96       44.3     3.76      48.9
## 9 Player 18      24    23 0.958      44.3     3.85      48.3
## 10 Player 110    23    22 0.957      41.4     3.74      43.9
## # i 87 more rows
## # i 2 more variables: avg_velocity <dbl>, avg_total_time <dbl>
```

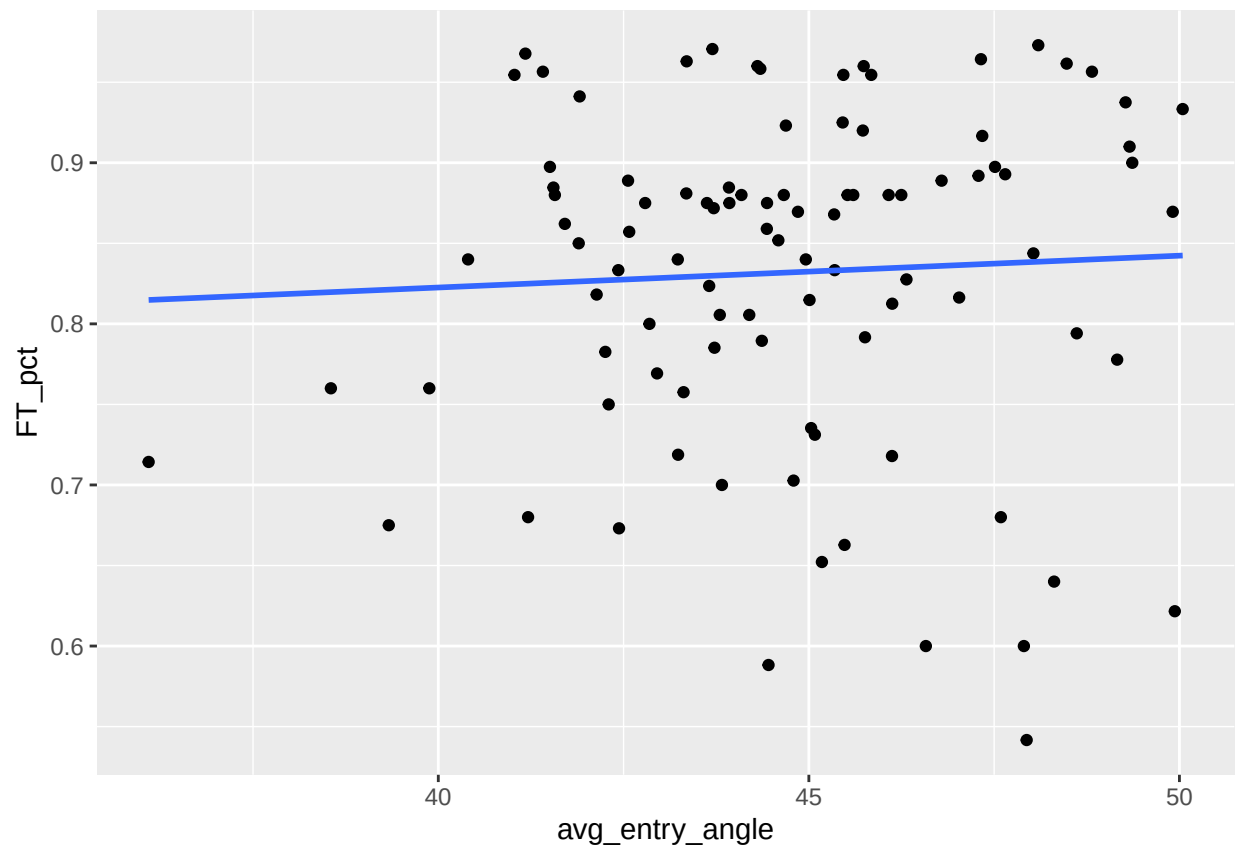
```
library(knitr)
player_summary_corr <- player_summary %>%
  select(-Name) %>%
  cor(use = "complete.obs")

kable(player_summary_corr)
```

	attempts	makes	FT_pct	avg_entry_angle	avg_arc	avg_release_angle	avg_velocity	avg_total_time
attempts	1.0000000	0.9861001	-	0.0806538	0.0454343	0.0920546	0.1433251	0.2028130
		0.1014963						
makes	0.9861001	1.0000000	0.0350878	0.0936059	0.0324079	0.1284937	0.1719497	0.2017040
FT_pct	-	0.0350878	1.0000000	0.0524340	-	0.1764490	0.1798612	-
	0.1014963			0.0479984				0.0883755
avg_entry_angle	0.0806538	0.0936059	0.0524340	1.0000000	0.5649433	0.7733363	0.1803424	-
								0.0682254
avg_arc	0.0454343	0.0324079	-	0.5649433	1.0000000	0.4525391	0.1073298	0.3180805
		0.0479984						
avg_release_angle	0.0920546	0.1284937	0.1764490	0.7733363	0.4525391	1.0000000	0.4802947	0.1672820
avg_velocity	0.1433251	0.1719497	0.1798612	0.1803424	0.1073298	0.4802947	1.0000000	-
								0.0298858
avg_total_time	0.2028130	0.2017040	-	-0.0682254	0.3180805	0.1672820	-	1.0000000
		0.0883755					0.0298858	

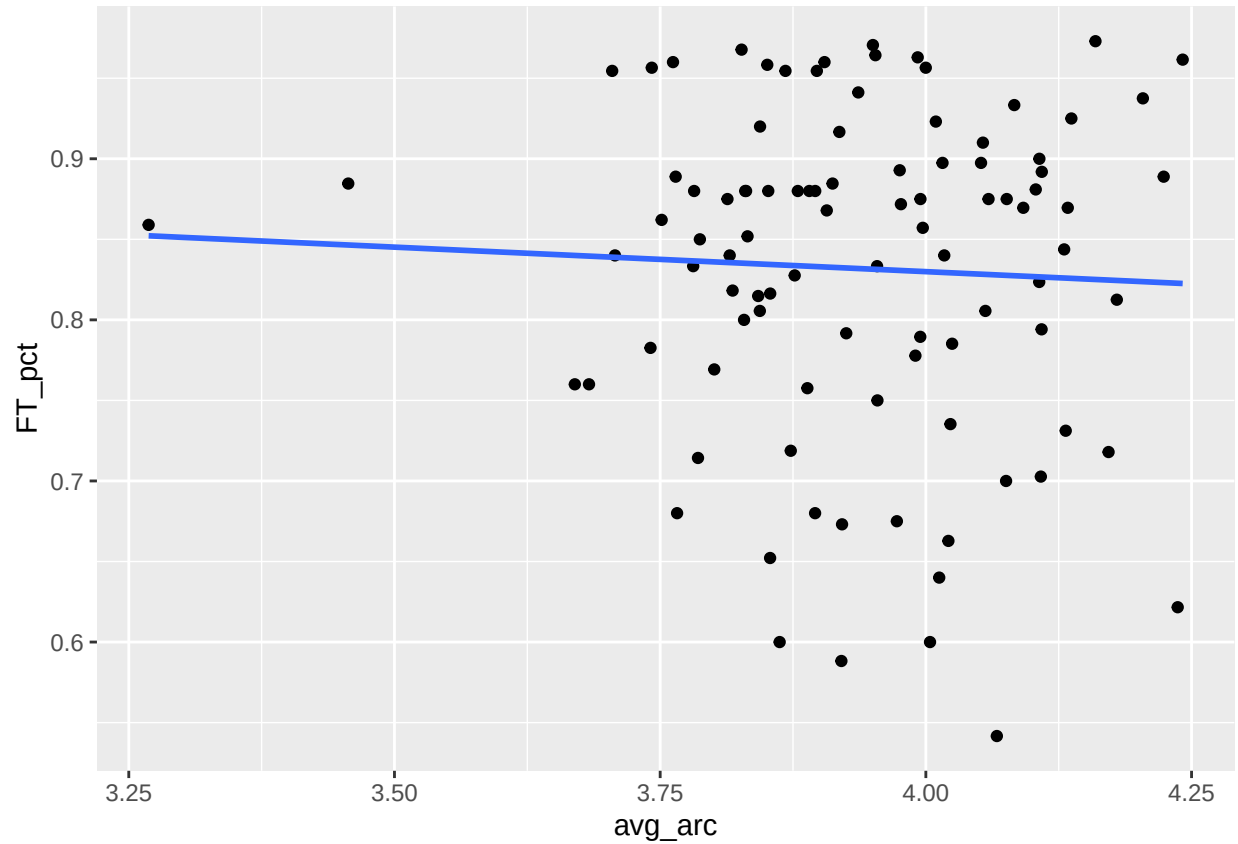
```
ggplot(player_summary,
  aes(x = avg_entry_angle, y = FT_pct)) +
  geom_point() +
  geom_smooth(method = "lm", se = FALSE)
```

```
## 'geom_smooth()' using formula = 'y ~ x'
```



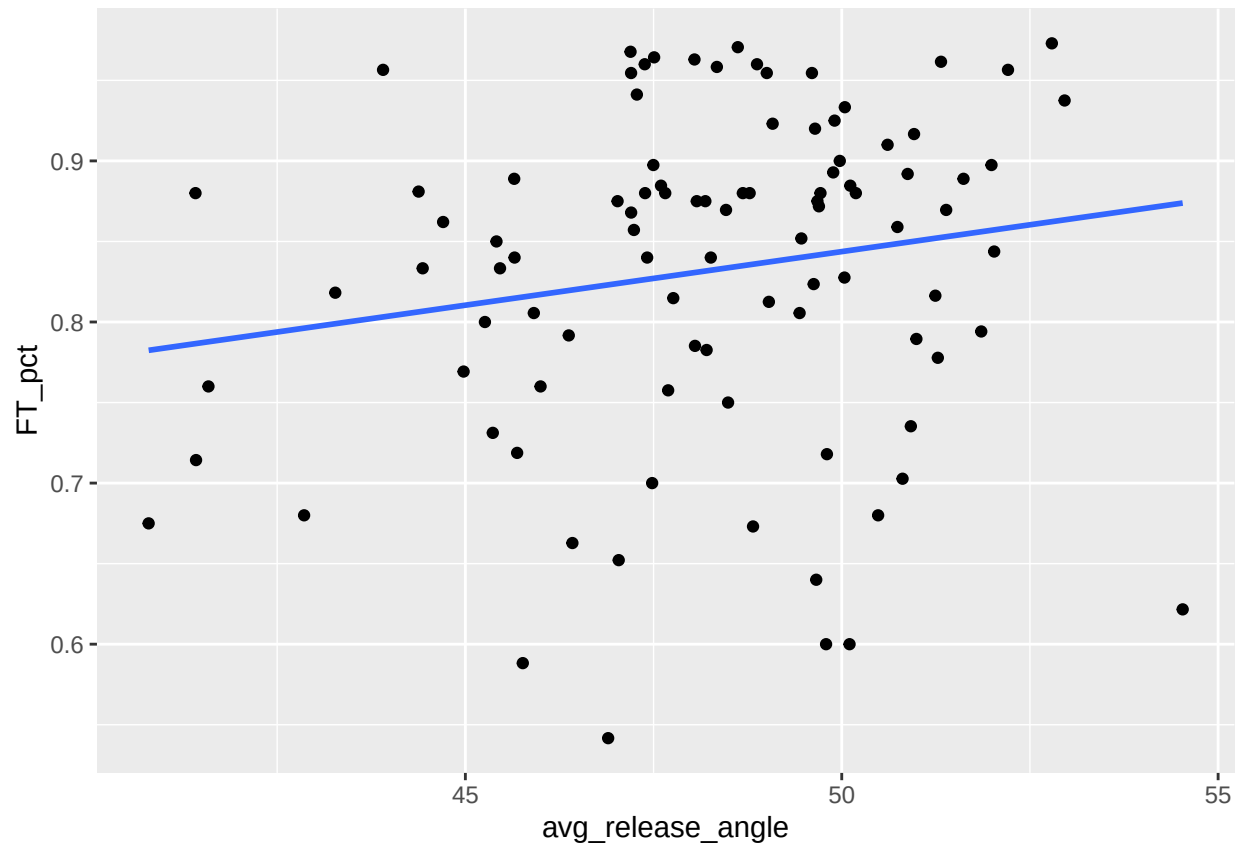
```
ggplot(player_summary,
       aes(x = avg_arc, y = FT_pct)) +
  geom_point() +
  geom_smooth(method = "lm", se = FALSE)
```

```
## 'geom_smooth()' using formula = 'y ~ x'
```



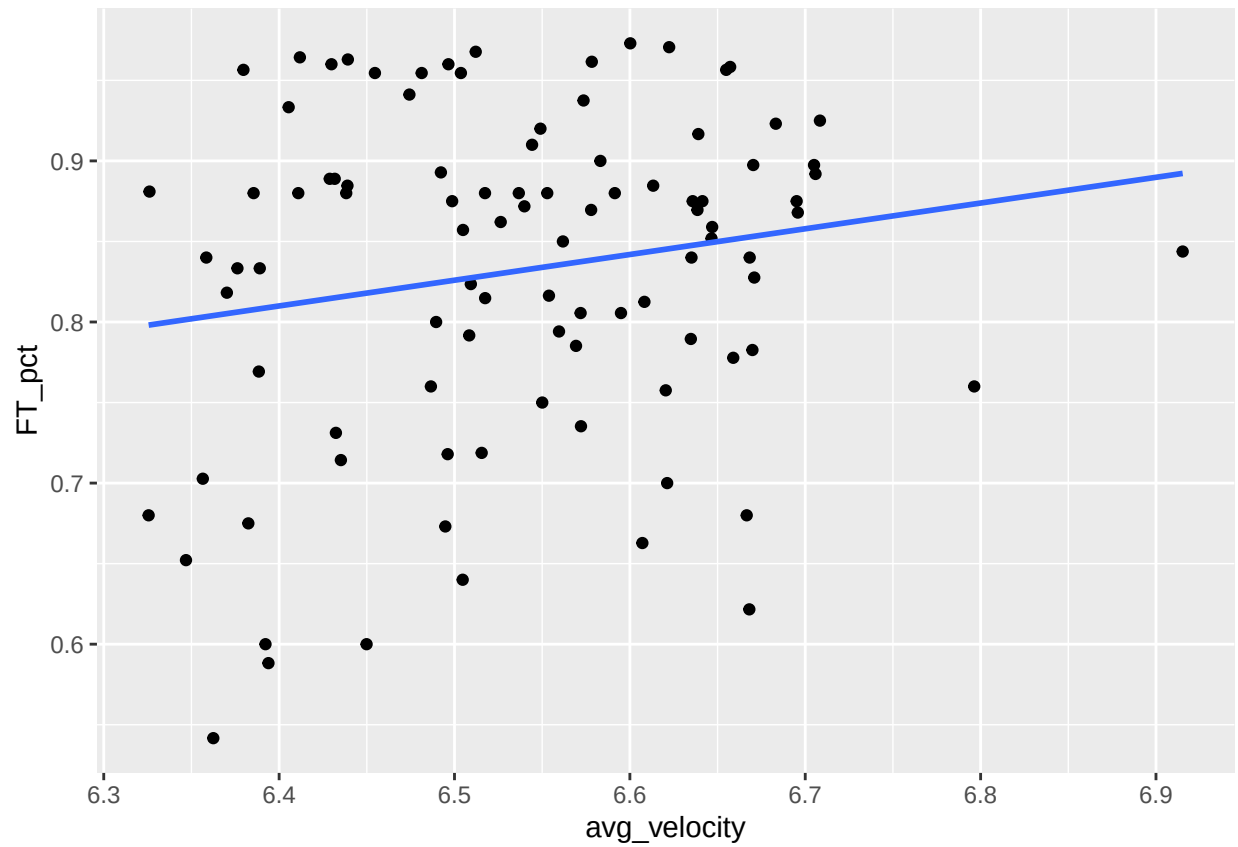
```
ggplot(player_summary,
       aes(x = avg_release_angle, y = FT_pct)) +
  geom_point() +
  geom_smooth(method = "lm", se = FALSE)
```

```
## 'geom_smooth()' using formula = 'y ~ x'
```



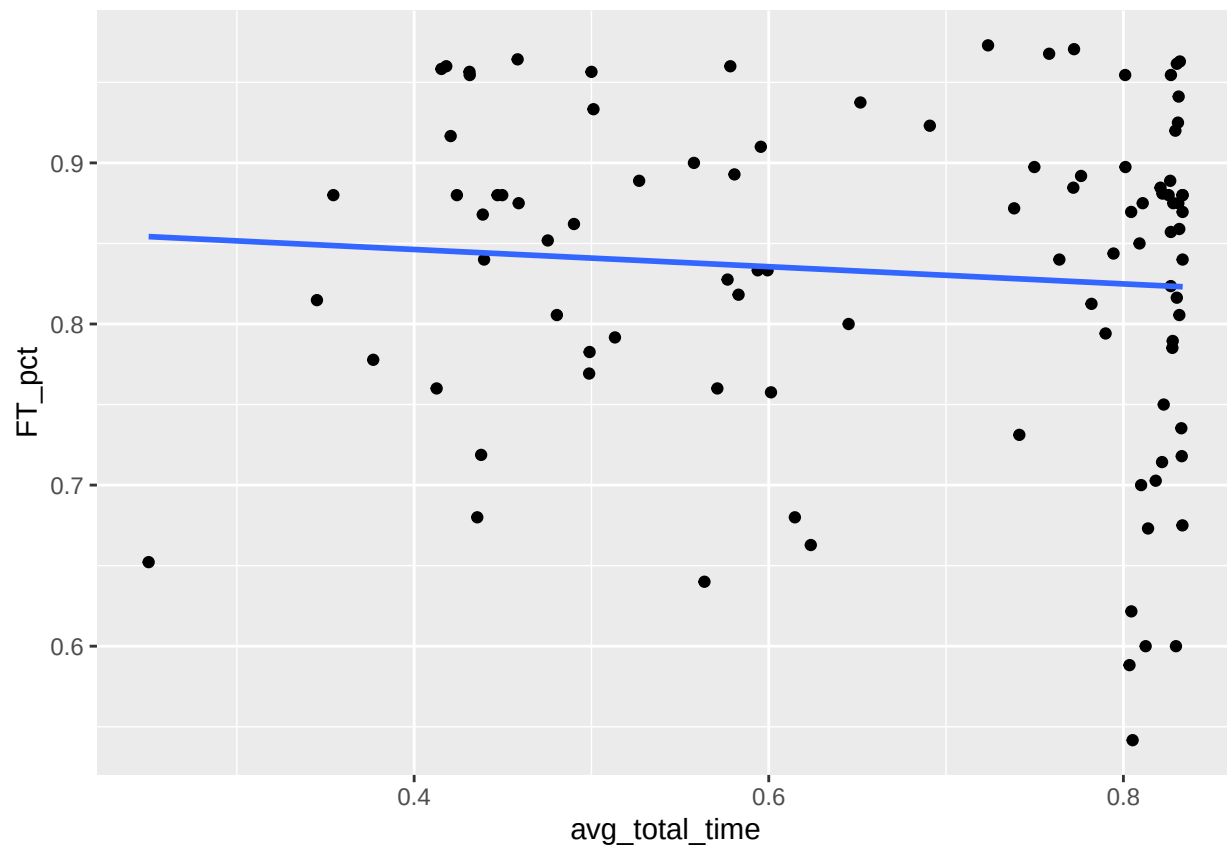
```
ggplot(player_summary,  
  aes(x = avg_velocity, y = FT_pct)) +  
  geom_point() +  
  geom_smooth(method = "lm", se = FALSE)
```

```
## 'geom_smooth()' using formula = 'y ~ x'
```



```
ggplot(player_summary,  
  aes(x = avg_total_time, y = FT_pct)) +  
  geom_point() +  
  geom_smooth(method = "lm", se = FALSE)
```

```
## 'geom_smooth()' using formula = 'y ~ x'
```



add other vars

```
freethrows_20 %>%
  group_by(Shot.Type) %>%
  count()
```

```
## # A tibble: 2 x 2
## # Groups:   Shot.Type [2]
##   Shot.Type      n
##   <chr>         <int>
## 1 Catch and Shoot  452
## 2 Off the Dribble 3264
```